Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A112T
Cultures
Main – All Branches
Midterm Exam

2025-2026/Fall Semester
Date: 18 Nov. 2025
2:30 – 4:30

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 2 Hours

INSTRUCTIONS

This Exam consists of TWO PARTS.

Part 1 contains 3 Short Answer Questions. You must choose TWO and fully answer them in PARAGRAPH FORMAT.

Part 2 contains 2 Essay Questions. You must choose ONE of them and fully answer it in ESSAY FORMAT.

Write the question number next to each answer.

Do not answer more questions than required.

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Part 1: Short Answer Questions
(10 points = 5 points for each answer)

Please choose TWO of the following questions and respond to them in paragraph format. Each answer should be approximately 80 words long, addressing all relevant aspects of the question with appropriate evidence from the course material. Ensure that each paragraph includes a clear topic sentence, supporting details, and a conclusion.

1. What was the significance of the **'City Dionysia festival'** in ancient Athens?
2. What was the **'Panathenaia festival,'** and which **god** did it honor?
3. What kinds of **events** and **activities** were held in the **'Circus Maximus'**?

Part 2: Essay Questions
(20 points)

Please choose ONE of the essay prompts below and write a comprehensive response in essay format. Your essay should be around 350 words, covering all relevant aspects of the question and backed by evidence from the course material. Make sure to structure your essay with an introduction, multiple body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

4. Fully elaborate on **the Agora's significance in the daily lives of Athenian citizens**, how it affected their participation in **politics**, **religion**, **laws**, and **commerce**, and what it reveals about their **culture**. Use **examples** from history and archaeology to support your ideas.

   Use these questions to help structure your essay and ensure all required aspects are covered:

   a. What was the agora in ancient Athens, and what were its main purposes for citizens?
   b. How did the agora serve as a political center and affect citizens' participation in government and democracy?
   c. In what ways did the agora play a role in religious activities and ceremonies for Athenians?
   d. How did the agora connect to the making and enforcing of laws in ancient Athens?
   e. What was the importance of the agora for commerce and daily trade among Athenians?
   f. How does the agora help us understand Athenian culture and public life?

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5. How does **the Colosseum** reflect **Roman culture, social structure, and values** through its **history**, **design**, and the **events** held there?

Use these questions to help structure your essay and ensure all required aspects are covered:

a. **Definition and Functions:** What was the Colosseum, and what were its main purposes in ancient Rome?
b. **Design and Symbolism:** How does the Colosseum's architecture and design reflect Roman engineering skills and their desire to impress and control the public?
c. **Events and Entertainment:** What types of events were held in the Colosseum, and what do these events reveal about Roman society's values and priorities?
d. **Social Structure:** How did the seating arrangement and access to the Colosseum reflect the strict social hierarchy of ancient Rome?
e. **Cultural Lessons:** What can we learn about ancient Roman culture, power, and values by studying the Colosseum and its history?

End of the Exam!

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